Conversation track 15, 17, 18

Selena checked into her hotel an hour ago. Now she's back at the front desk, talking to Liam.

Selena: **Sorry to bother you, but** there's a problem with my room.

Liam: **I'm sorry to hear that.** What seems to be the trouble?

Selena: The air conditioning **doesn't seem to** work, and it's rather hot.

Liam: **I do apologize.** I'll have someone take a look right away.

Selena: Thank you. Also, **I was wondering if** I could change rooms. It's a bit noisy.

Liam: Of course. **Let me see what I can do.** How about the top floor?

Selena: That would be lovely. Sorry to be such a pain.

Liam: Not at all. And breakfast is on us tomorrow, to make up for it.

Speak Like a Native track 16

1. Sorry to bother you, but there's a problem with my room.

weak: "to", "but"
linking: "there's‿a"
strong: "problem", "room"

Giọng xuống rồi hơi lên ở "bother you" (lịch sự, báo trước lời phàn nàn), ngừng ngắn. "there's a" nối thành "đe-zơ"; giọng Anh không đọc /r/: /ðeəz/.

2. I do apologize.

strong: "do"

"do" được nhấn mạnh để lời xin lỗi nghe chân thành hơn (đây không phải câu hỏi). "apologize" nhấn âm thứ hai: /əˈpɑːlədʒaɪz/ "ơ-pa-lơ-jaiz".

3. Also, I was wondering if I could change rooms.

weak: "was", "could"
linking: "wondering‿if‿I"
strong: "change rooms"

"was", "could" đọc nhẹ /wəz/, /kəd/. "wondering if I" nối thành "wan-đơ-ri-ngi-phai". Giọng xuống rồi hơi lên ở "rooms": lời đề nghị nghe khiêm tốn.

- Phàn nàn lịch sự: nói chậm, giọng nhẹ, xuống rồi hơi lên ở cuối cụm (bother you…, change rooms…), không xuống giọng gắt.
- Muốn lời xin lỗi chân thành hơn, nhấn mạnh trợ động từ: I DO apologize.
- Trong câu đề nghị, các từ nhỏ đọc nhẹ: I was wondering if I could… → "ai-wơz-wan-đơ-ri-ngi-phai-cơd".

Role Play track 20

A: Sorry to bother you, but there's a problem with my room.

B: _____. What seems to be the trouble?

A: The air conditioning doesn't seem to work, and it's rather hot.

B: I do apologize. I'll have someone _____ right away.

A: Thank you. Also, I was wondering if I could change rooms. It's a bit noisy.

B: Of course. Let me see what I can do. How about the top floor?

A: That would be lovely. Sorry to be such a pain.

B: Not at all. And _____ is on us tomorrow, to make up for it.

Study Notes

What seems to be the trouble?
Quý khách gặp vấn đề gì ạ?
Câu hỏi lịch sự của nhân viên khi khách báo có sự cố; "seems to be" làm câu hỏi nhẹ nhàng hơn.
Cách nói tương đương: What's the problem?

Sorry to be such a pain.
Xin lỗi đã làm phiền anh nhiều quá.
"be a pain" (thân mật) là gây phiền phức, làm mất công người khác. Hay nói sau khi đã nhờ vả hoặc phàn nàn nhiều.
Cách nói tương đương: Sorry for all the trouble.

Grammar Focus

Phàn nàn khéo léo

Mở đầu bằng lời xin lỗi (Sorry to bother you, but…), dùng "seem to" cho nhẹ bớt, và dùng câu gián tiếp (I was wondering if…) thay cho đòi hỏi.

Sorry to bother you, but my key doesn't work.
The shower **doesn't seem to** be working.
I was wondering if I could get a refund.

Đáp lại lời phàn nàn

Thể hiện sự cảm thông, xin lỗi, rồi đưa ra giải pháp. "I'll have someone + V" nghĩa là tôi sẽ cho người đến làm việc gì đó.

I'm so sorry about that. It won't happen again.
I'll have someone bring up fresh towels.
I'll look into it right away.

Substitution Drill track 21

1. I'm sorry to hear that. What seems to be the trouble?
   a. Oh dear
   b. I'm so sorry
   c. That's not good

2. I'll have someone take a look right away.
   a. fix it
   b. bring you a fan
   c. check the unit

3. And breakfast is on us tomorrow, to make up for it.
   a. dinner
   b. the spa
   c. room service